

RENOWN — ESCALATION CAMPAIGN

A fast, battle-driven mode for 2+ players. Ten+ turns.

DICE PRINCIPLE

A successful roll is written as **X+**: roll that number or higher on a **d6**. Apply modifiers to the **roll**: **+1** per bonus, **−1** per penalty: each negative modifier requires your roll to be one higher to succeed, each positive modifier one lower. **If a 7 or more is ever needed to succeed a roll, it automatically fails; if a 1 or less is ever needed, it automatically passes.** **Note:** if a roll automatically passes or fails but a natural result could still trigger an effect, you still roll the die to see whether that effect triggers.

A **natural** roll is the die before modifiers. A **natural 6** triggers **Cleave, Shatter Armor, Destroy Shield and Riposte** (and a natural-6 Save fails against Poison).

The rolls: **Roll-off** — higher **Seizes the Initiative**; **to Strike** — roll $\geq$ to-Strike number; **Parry** — roll $\geq$ 5 (Improved 4+), natural 6 = Riposte; **to Save** — roll − AP + shield bonus $\geq$ armor value; **Recover** — roll $\geq$ X; **Panic** — roll $\geq$ Morale value; **Break** — roll $\geq$ Morale value.

SETUP

Each player starts with an **army composition** of **25 Levy retinues, Farm Tools, Cloth armor, no shield**. All four Domains (**Industry, Prowess, Piety, Cunning**) start **Untested** (no effect). No Pursuits, 0 Victory Points (VP). Every Battle is fought at an army size of **25**; what carries over between Battles is your **Standings, Pursuits, unlocks, and VP**.

TURN SEQUENCE

1 — BATTLE. Pair off and fight one Battle (rotate pairings each turn).

Result	VP
Decisive Win: Reduce the enemy army to zero or cause a Rout.	+3
Minor Victory: The enemy army Fell Back.	+2
Lose, but end it via a successful Fall Back with 1+ retinue remaining.	+1
Lose any other way (wiped out, Routed, failed Fall Back).	0

2 — ADVANCEMENT (all players simultaneously):

- **Unlock one Domain Standing:** advance any one Domain one step — Untested → Rising → Established → Sovereign, if the prior standing is already unlocked.
- **Perform one Build Action:** construct one Pursuit whose build requirements you satisfy.
- **You may change your army to any other composition you have unlocked.** You must announce it before the end of the turn. If it's an issue, both players play their army's composition face down and reveal simultaneously.

VICTORY

After **10 Battles**, highest VP wins. **Tie:** keep playing full turns until one tied player **leads by 3 VP**.

EDICTS (+1 VP each)

Gain **+1 VP** every time you reach a **Sovereign** Standing in any Domain, or **complete (master) a Monument:** *Advanced Blast Furnace, Royal Pavilion, Preceptory of the Knight's Templar, Ministry of Military Strategy, Outrider Intercept Post.*

BUILDING

A Build Action constructs **one Pursuit**; the only requirement is its **Build Action Requirement**. Its **Innate** effect applies at once; its **Mastery** effect once every **Pursuit** in its **Mastery Requirement** is also built. You may freely re-equip before each Battle with anything unlocked.

BATTLE WALKTHROUGH

Begin the Battle — roll off for the Initiative. Each player rolls one d6 — **+1 if you won your last Battle** — re-rolling ties. The higher roller **Seizes the Initiative**: they are the **Attacker** for this Battle and gain **+1 Initiative in the first Skirmish**; their opponent is the **Defender**.

Fought as a series of **Skirmishes** — repeat these steps each Skirmish until the Battle ends; rule detail is in the Glossary.

- 1. Form the Field.** Each player places the maximum retinues available into the field, up to **10** retinues in the front line — one attack each — and up to 5 in reserve to replace losses before striking back.
- 2. Choose Tactics.** Both players secretly pick one **Tactic**, then reveal simultaneously.
- 3. Declare equipment.** The **Attacker** names their equipment first; the **Defender** then names theirs.
- 4. Initiative.** Initiative runs from **−2 to +2**. The higher Initiative Strikes first this Skirmish. At **−2 or lower you Blunder** — your **Strike** value cannot be improved beyond 6+.
- 5. Roll to Strike.** Roll a d6 for each front-line retinue. To calculate the to-Strike result needed: the Retinue's to-Strike, plus positive modifiers, minus 1 per Fatigue token, to a maximum of 6+, and then any other remaining negative modifiers.
- 6. Strike and defend.** Resolve the first player's **Strikes** — **Parry** (immediately resolve **Ripostes**), then **Save**, then **Recover**; the rest are casualties. Casualties leave the field immediately, lowering its **Field** count.
- 7. Panic check.** If any army takes **5 or more casualties** this Skirmish from combat at any time, it takes a **Panic check** immediately: roll a d6 per retinue in the field, **up to 5 dice**. If the result is ever **modified to require 7 or more, that army Routs instead**. You Panic at most once per Skirmish.
- 8. Strike back.** The other player Strikes the same way, if able.
- 9. Lose Endurance.** Each army that participated loses 1 Endurance. A player's army at 0 Endurance is **Fatigued**.
- 10. Break check.** Each **Fatigued** player's field takes a **break check** — before it gains a token: roll a d6 per retinue in the field, **up to 5 dice**, roll against **its modified Morale value** — modified negatively by 1 per Fatigue token and by other positive modifiers. Failures are casualties; a break check never triggers a Panic check. A Morale value ever **modified to 7 or more Routs the whole army**.
- 11. Fatigue token.** Then each Fatigued side gains a **Fatigue token** — each is **−1 to its Strike and Morale rolls**, and they stack.
- 12. End the Skirmish.** The Battle ends if a player's army size is reduced to 0, Routs, or successfully **Falls Back**. Otherwise start the next Skirmish at step 1. You cannot Fall Back during the first and second Skirmish of any Battle.

ARMORY REFERENCE

RETINUES (the physical capability of your Troops)

Retinue	Strike	Endur	Morale	Notes	Unlock
Levy	4+	3	5	—	—
Man-at-Arms	3+	2	4	—	Coliseum
Sergeant	2+	2	4	—	War College
Knight Templar	2+	2	4	Unshakable	Preceptory

WEAPON TIERS

Five tiers, worst to best: **Crude** • **Cast** • **Wrought** • **Forged** • **Crafted**. Each tier is unlocked by an Industry Pursuit (see that Pursuit's effect under Pursuits). A weapon's tier is shown in its Tier column.

MELEE WEAPONS (Unwieldy = cannot gain Initiative from Tactics; vice versa for Steady)

Weapon	AP	Init	Tags	Note	Tier
Farm Tools	0	0	—	—	Crude
Cudgel	−1	−1	2H, Unwieldy	—	Crude
Pitchfork	0	+1	2H, Unwieldy	—	Crude
Daggers	0	+1	Nimble, 2H, Shatter Armor	—	Cast
Short Sword	−1	0	Steady	—	Cast
Spears	−1	+1	Unwieldy	—	Cast
Arming Sword	−1	0	Steady, Shatter Armor	—	Wrought
Pike	−2	+1	Unwieldy, Shatter Armor, 2H	—	Wrought
Flail	−2	−1	Cleave	—	Wrought
Halberd	−3	0	2H	—	Wrought
Battle Axe	−2	−1	Unstoppable, 2H, Cleave	—	Wrought
Cavalry Spear	−2	0	Unwieldy, Steady	Needs Stable; no Tower Shield or Crossbow dual	Wrought
Bastard Sword	−3	0	Steady, Shatter Armor	—	Forged
2HBastard	−3	0	Cleave, 2H, Unwieldy	—	Forged
Lance	−4	+1	Steady, Unwieldy, Shatter Armor, Unstoppable	Needs Stable; no Tower Shield	Forged
Morningstar	−3	−1	Unwieldy, Destroy Shield, Cleave	—	Forged
War Hammer	−8	−1	Unwieldy, Destroy Shield, Unstoppable, 2H, Shatter Armor	—	Forged
Poleaxe	−4	+1	Steady, 2H, Unstoppable, Shatter Armor	—	Crafted

RANGED (all have Deflect; Fletchery to equip, Tiltyard to dual-equip. Deflect: −1 to Parry saves from Deflect weapons; cannot be Riposted)

Weapon	AP	Init	Tags	Note	Tier
Hunting Bow	−1	+2	2H, Shatter Armor	—	Crude
Longbow	−2	+2	Shatter Armor, 2H	—	Cast
Javelin	−3	+1	Shatter Armor, Steady, Unstoppable, One Shot	—	Wrought
Crossbow	−4	0	Shatter Armor, Unwieldy, Unstoppable	Tower Shield only (no other shield permitted)	Forged
Pilum	−5	+1	Steady, Destroy Shield, Unstoppable, One Shot, Shatter Armor	—	Crafted

SHIELDS (require Joinery + the matching metal-tier building)

Shield	Save	Init	Tags	Tier
Wooden	+1	−1	Unwieldy	Crude
Kite	+1	0	Steady	Cast
Scutum	+1	−1	Unwieldy, −1 to Strike	Wrought
Tower	+2	−1	−1 to Strike, Unwieldy	Forged
Heater	+1	0	−1 to Strike, Immune Destroy Shield	Crafted

ARMOR (Save target; heavier Armor grants Unwieldy — nothing happens if Unwieldy stacks)

Armor	Save	Tags	Unlocked by	Tier
Cloth	6+	—	—	Crude
Leather	5+	—	Tannery	Cast
Chainmail	4+	Unwieldy	Armory	Wrought
Full Plate	3+	Unwieldy	Gilded Foundry	Forged
Gothic Plate	2+	Unwieldy	Advanced Blast Furnace	Crafted

PURSUIITS

Organised by Domain (colour-coded); rows alternate in the Domain tint and *monuments are the purple rows. Build Action Req = the Domain Standing only (the sole build requirement); every Pursuit listed under **Mastery Req** is needed to master, not to build.*

■ Industry ■ Prowess ■ Piety ■ Cunning ■ Edict (Sovereign standing or Monument)

INDUSTRY

Pursuit	Build Action Req	Mastery Req	Innate Effect	Mastery Effect
Furnace	—	—	Cast weapons	—
Blacksmith	Rising Industry	Furnace	—	Wrought weapons
Forge	Established Industry	Blacksmith, Furnace	—	Forged weapons
Tannery	—	Animal Husbandry	—	Leather armor
Armory	Rising Industry	Tannery, Blacksmith	—	Chainmail
Gilded Foundry	Established Industry	Armory, Blacksmith	Full Plate	Planishing
Master Workshop	Established Industry	Forge, Blacksmith	—	Serrated
Joinery	Rising Industry	Carpentry	—	Shields
Stable	—	Animal Husbandry, Blacksmith or Carpentry	—	Cavalry weapons (Lance, Cavalry Spear)
Advanced Blast Furnace	Sovereign Industry	Gilded Foundry, Master Workshop, Blacksmith, Stable, Forge	—	Crafted tier

PROWESS

Pursuit	Build Action Req	Mastery Req	Innate Effect	Mastery Effect
Conditioning Field	—	—	+1 Endurance	—
Coliseum	Rising Prowess	Conditioning Field	—	Man-at-Arms unlock
Fletcher	—	Carpentry	—	Ranged weapons
Grand Tournament	Established Prowess	Conditioning Field, Coliseum	Improved Parry	Riposte
Tiltyard	Established Prowess	Fletcher, Coliseum	Dual-equip; gain Unwieldy	Immune Unwieldy
War College	Established Prowess	Levy Hall, Academy	—	Sergeant unlock
Royal Pavilion	Sovereign Prowess	Grand Tournament, Tiltyard	Immune Strain	Drilled, Nimble
Ministry of Military Strategy	Sovereign Prowess	University, War College	Seize the Initiative in Skirmish 1 (the enemy never can); ignore every Tactic to-Strike penalty	Gain +1 Initiative and +1 to Strike each Skirmish; maximum Initiative raised by 1 (to +3)

PIETY

Pursuit	Build Action Req	Mastery Req	Innate Effect	Mastery Effect
Apothecary	—	Herb Garden	—	Heal 4
Infirmary	—	Apothecary, Herb Garden	—	Recover 6
Hospitaller	Established Piety	Apothecary, Infirmary	Recover +1	Recover +1
Preceptory of the Knight's Templar	Sovereign Piety + Established Prowess	Monastery, Pilgrimage Site, Hospitaller, Abbey	Immune Panic	Knight Templar unlock

CUNNING

Pursuit	Build Action Req	Mastery Req	Innate Effect	Mastery Effect
Toxicarium	Rising Cunning	Academy	—	Poison
Outrider Intercept Post	Sovereign Cunning	Caravanery, Cipher Chamber	Once each battle (Skirmish 1), see the enemy's Tactic before you choose yours	Every Skirmish, see the enemy's Tactic before you choose yours

NON-COMBAT ENABLERS

No battle effect of their own — built only as prerequisites or mastery requirements.

Pursuit	Build Action Req	Purpose	Feeds into
Carpentry	—	Build Timer –1 ; +100; Craft +1	Joinery, Fletchery
Animal Husbandry	—	+400, Natural	Tannery, Stable
Levy Hall	Rising Prowess	Upkeep –200	War College
Academy	—	Influence 1 to Council Envoys	War College, Ministry, Toxicarium
University	—	+1 Influence per Domain you are Rising	Ministry, Cipher Chamber
Herb Garden / Alchemy	—	Efficient Hamlet ; Craft +1	Apothecary, Infirmary
Monastery	Established Piety	Other players can't Oppose your Piety Envoys ; Efficient Abbey	Preceptory (mastery)
Pilgrimage Site	Rising Piety	Doubt 1 to all other players without a Pilgrimage Site; Efficient Reliquary	Preceptory (mastery)
Abbey	Established Piety	Once/turn: Influence 1 another player's Piety Envoy	Preceptory (mastery)
Caravanery	Established Cunning	Influence –1 to Intercept Caravan actions targeting your Settlements ; Craft +2	Outrider Intercept Post
Cipher Chamber	Sovereign Cunning; University	Once/turn, select any active timer you did not select last turn: increase the timer +1	Outrider Intercept Post

GLOSSARY

2H — Two-handed: no shield. A Bastard Sword may choose its profile during the declare equipment phase.

AP — Armor Penetration — a weapon's (negative) modifier to the defender's Save roll. Reduce the result of the roll by 1 per AP.

Attacker / Defender — Set by the roll-off. Each Skirmish the Attacker declares equipment first; the Defender then responds.

Battle — One fight between two players (Turn step 1), resolved as a series of Skirmishes until a side is wiped out, Routs, or Falls Back.

Blocked — –1 Initiative in the first Skirmish (negated by Immune Blocked).

Break check — Taken by each Fatigued side's field every Skirmish, just before it gains its Fatigue token. Roll Morale (up to 5 dice); failures are casualties, but a break check never triggers a Panic check. Unshakable retinues auto-hold.

Casualty — A retinue removed from the field — from an unsaved Strike or a failed Panic or Break check.

Cleave — Each natural 6 to Strike adds one extra Strike.

Deflect — Every ranged weapon has it: a ranged Strike is –1 to Parry and never Ripostes.

Destroy Shield — A natural 6 against a shield-bearer destroys their shield for the rest of the Battle.

Drilled — No Endurance loss in the first Skirmish.

Dual-equip — Carry two weapons at once (e.g. melee + ranged). Granted by the Tiltyard, which also gives Unwieldy until its mastery removes it.

Edict — A scoring achievement worth +1 VP: reach a Sovereign Standing, or complete (master) a Monument.

Endurance — A side's stamina. Each side that fights loses 1 per Skirmish; at 0 it becomes Fatigued.

Fall Back — A controlled retreat that ends the Battle with at least one retinue left from the Fall Back tactic — a partial success worth +1 VP.

Fatigue token — Each token is –1 to that army's Strike rolls and Morale rolls for the rest of the Battle. They stack.

Fatigued — A side at 0 Endurance. It cannot Parry, Riposte or Recover; each Skirmish its field takes a break check, then it gains a Fatigue token.

Field — Your retinues in play — front line (up to 10) plus reserve (up to 5). Casualties leave the field at once, lowering its count.

Heal X — At the end of each Skirmish, for every X casualties you took from Strikes, return 1 retinue to your Army.

Immune [keyword] — Cancels that keyword as it applies to you — e.g. Immune Unwieldy, Strain, Blocked, Panic or Destroy Shield.

Improved Parry — Your Parry succeeds on 4+ instead of 5+.

Initiative — Decides who Strikes first each Skirmish (higher first). Runs –2 to +2 (Ministry can raise the maximum to +3). At –2 or lower you Blunder — your Strike value cannot be improved beyond 6+.

Monument — A Domain's capstone Pursuit (the purple rows). Completing one scores its Edict (+1 VP) and grants a powerful effect. Only one of each Monument can be built each game.

Morale — A test used to determine whether retinues Flee as casualties. Break and Panic checks both roll it: a d6 per retinue in the field, up to 5 dice, each ≥ its modified Morale value; failures are casualties. Any such check ever modified to 7 or more Routs the whole army.

Natural roll — The number on the die before any modifiers. A natural 6 triggers Cleave, Shatter Armor, Destroy Shield and Riposte — modifiers never change what counts as 'natural'.

Nimble — +1 Initiative in the first Skirmish.

One Shot — A ranged weapon can be equipped in the first Skirmish only. If you have no other weapon, you must use Farm Tools after the first Skirmish.

Panic check — Taken at once by a side that suffered 5 or more casualties in a Skirmish, before it Strikes back. Roll a d6 per retinue in the field, up to 5 dice; Immune Panic auto-passes it.

Parry — Roll a d6 to cancel a Strike on a 5+ (a natural 6 is a Riposte). –1 versus Unstoppable and versus ranged (to a maximum of 6+). Cannot Parry while Fatigued. Shatter Armor can only be Riposted.

Planishing — Reduces an incoming Strike's AP by 1, to a minimum of 0. (Gilded Foundry mastery.)

Poison — The defender's Save fails on a natural 6 (Toxicarium mastery).

Recover X — After a failed Parry and Save, roll a d6: a result of X+ saves the retinue. Cannot Recover while Fatigued.

Riposte — A Parry of a natural 6 cancels the Strike and Strikes back once; it is also the only way to Parry a Shatter Armor Strike.

Rout — The army breaks and leaves the Battle (you lose it). A Panic or break check ever modified to 7 or more Routs the whole army automatically.

Save — The defender's roll to avoid a casualty: roll a d6, add the weapon's AP (a negative) and the shield's Save bonus (a positive); the hit is saved on a result ≥ the armor value (Cloth 6+ ... Gothic Plate 2+).

Seize the Initiative — Won by the roll-off at the start of the Battle — the winner of their last Battle adds +1 to the roll. You become the Attacker and gain +1 Initiative in the first Skirmish. Some Tactics and the Ministry monument also grant it.

Serrated — Your Strikes worsen the enemy's Recover roll by 1 — enough to deny Recover entirely. (Master Workshop mastery.)

Shatter Armor — A natural 6 to Strike skips the armor Save entirely; only a Riposte or Recover can stop it.

Shield (–1 to Strike) — Attackers Striking a shield-bearer take –1 to the Strike roll.

Skirmish — One round of a Battle, run through the numbered Battle steps; a Battle repeats Skirmishes until it ends.

Steady — Your Initiative cannot be reduced by Tactics.

Strained — –1 Initiative every Skirmish (negated by Immune Strain).

Strike — A landed hit. Roll a d6, apply modifiers to the roll, and Strike on a result ≥ the to-Strike number. The target may then Parry, Save, and Recover.

Tactic — A choice both players make secretly and reveal together each Skirmish; it can shift Initiative and Strike rolls.

to-Strike — The d6 result a retinue needs to roll to successfully Strike. Bonuses add to the roll; penalties and Fatigue tokens subtract.

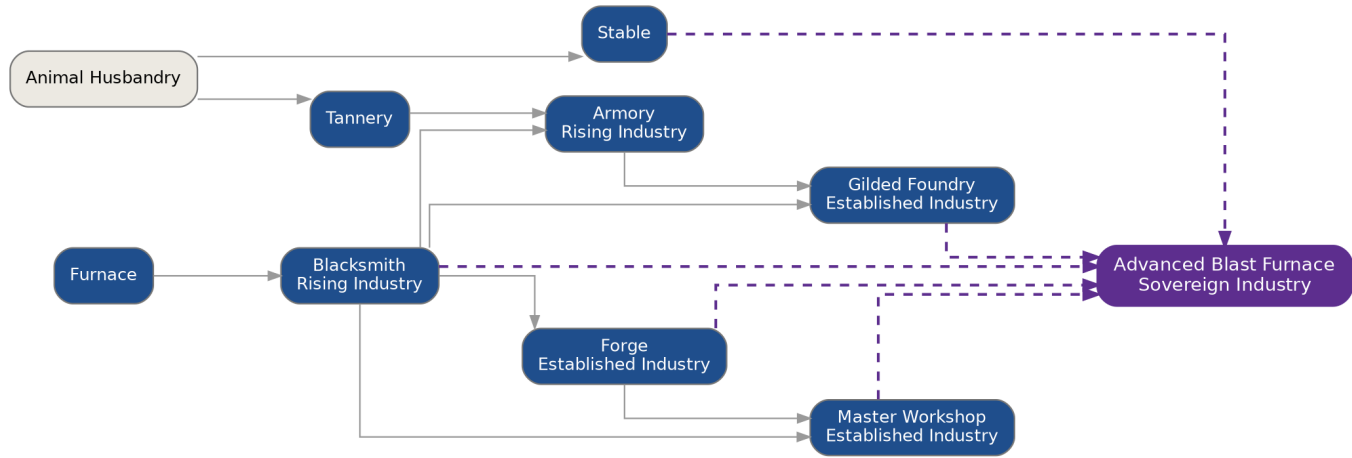
Unstoppable — Ignore the target shield's –1 to Strike, and the target's Parry is –1 against you.

Unwieldy — Your Initiative cannot be improved by Tactics.

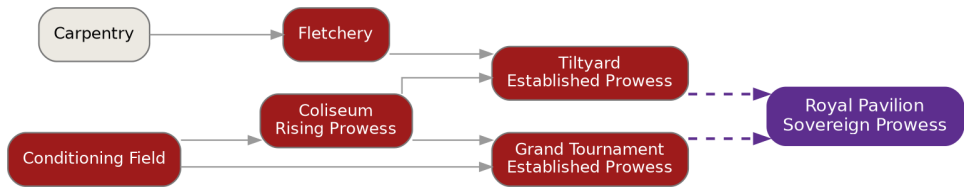
MONUMENT BUILD PATHS

Grey arrow = a Building you must build to master the one it points to. **Purple dashed arrow** = required to master the Monument (its Edict). Node colour = Domain; tag = the Standing it needs.

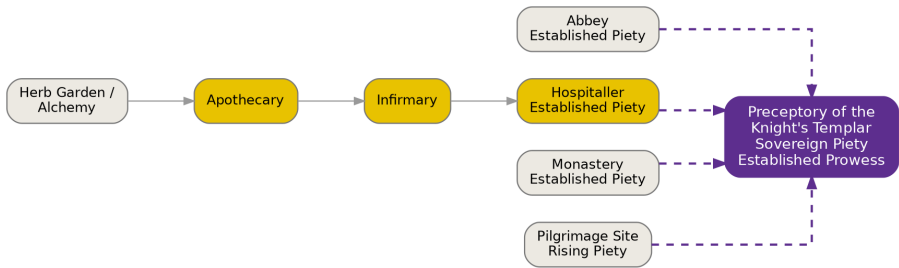
Advanced Blast Furnace



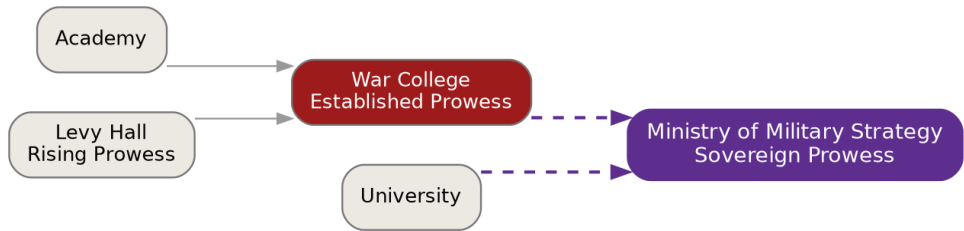
Royal Pavilion



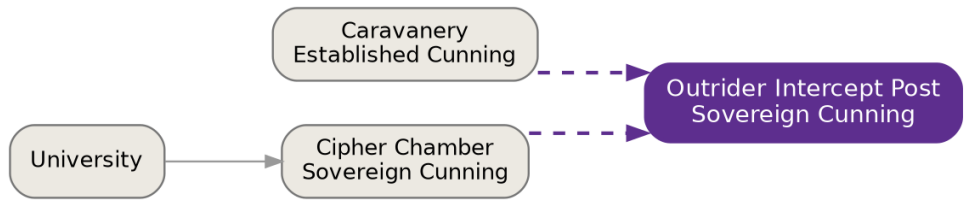
Preceptory of the Knight's Templar



Ministry of Military Strategy



Outrider Intercept Post



DOMAIN BOARDS — ONE GRID, BOTH PLAYERS

Each player tracks their own three columns (one shared Domain column). Cover every ability cell with a 40 mm base at setup; remove a base when you unlock that standing. A Sovereign cell also scores an Edict (+1 VP).

Domain	PLAYER 1			PLAYER 2		
	Rising	Established	Sovereign	Rising	Established	Sovereign
Industry	Build Action	Build Action	Build Action	Build Action	Build Action	Build Action
Prowess	Immune Blocked	Parry	Edict only	Immune Blocked	Parry	Edict only
Piety	Gain Established Piety	Improve Morale +1	Edict only	Gain Established Piety	Improve Morale +1	Edict only
Cunning	Foes gain Blocked	Gain Sovereign Cunning	Foes gain Strained	Foes gain Blocked	Gain Sovereign Cunning	Foes gain Strained

TACTIC MATRIX

Both players pick a Tactic in secret each Skirmish (Battle step 2), then reveal together. Find **your** Tactic down the left and your **opponent's** across the top — the cell shows the modifiers **you** gain that Skirmish. Your opponent reads their own row for theirs.

I = Initiative **H** = to-Strike (easier to hit) **S** = Save (harder to be killed). + helps you, – hurts you. **Battle ends** = the fight breaks off this Skirmish; **No combat** = both Flank — no engagement, but Endurance is still spent.

<i>You ↓ Foe →</i>	Scout	Ambush	Flank	Charge	Fight. Form.	Def. Form.	Fall Back
Scout	+1 I	+1 I	–1 I	+1 I	+1 I	+1 I	Battle ends
Ambush	–1 I +1 S	–1 I +1 S	+1 I –1 H	+1 I +1 H	+1 I +1 S	–1 H	Battle ends
Flank	+1 I	–1 I +1 H	No combat	–1 I	+1 I +1 H	+1 I	–1 I
Charge	–1 I	–1 I –1 S	+1 I	+1 H	+1 I –1 H	–1 I –1 S	+1 I +1 H
Fighting Formation	–1 I +1 H	–1 I –1 S	–1 I	–1 I +1 H	–1 I +1 H	+1 H	+1 H
Defensive Formation	–1 I +1 S	+1 S	–1 I +1 S	+1 I +1 H +1 S	+1 S	+1 S	Battle ends
Fall Back	Battle ends	Battle ends	+1 I +1 H	–1 I	—	Battle ends	Battle ends